agenda of foreign actors. For example, several international organizations were involved in the consultation and drafting of the Small and Medium Enterprise Law (Set Aung 2014, p. 7). There was international help drafting the Central Bank Law (Turnell 2014b, p. 190), and the current process of revising the Company Law is supported by the Asian Development Bank. Some laws have been passed as part of conditionality agreements set by international organizations, such as the Social Security Law.[36] While engagement with foreign expertise creates more opportunities to consider best practice, it has also led to local concerns and rumours of unwarranted foreign influence in the drafting process, resulting in new forms of conflict and tension.

THE FUTURE OF LAW REFORM IN MYANMAR: BEYOND CONFLICT?

Sarat and Kearns observed, "The existence of law stands as a monument to the hope that words can contain and control violence" (1993, p. 2). This is one way to view the legislative reform process in Myanmar — the text of legislation acting as a symbolic source of hope that the future will contain less conflict and violence. Yet legal reform is an inherently uncertain process, particularly in times of political transition. As I have suggested in this chapter, this uncertainty lies in the dual capacity of law to both manage and engender conflict.

The legislative agenda over the past few years in Myanmar is one indication of deep uncertainty in society and is an attempt to counter insecurity about the future. The priorities of the law reform agenda are telling of these tensions. This chapter has demonstrated how law reform is more a reflection of past patterns in lawmaking both in terms of law's relation to conflict and the textual features that determine this. It therefore maintains continuity in how law is used to manage and avoid conflict, particularly by preventing access to the courts. There is also the future potential for new laws to exacerbate conflict between individuals, or between individuals and the state. This adds to the sense of instability and insecurity about the future.

In terms of legislative reform beyond 2015, there are a large number of bills in progress that the new parliament, dominated by the NLD, may address from 2016. Yet given the dramatic shift from the USDP to the